

简单话 (Jiǎndānhuà) Language Specification

Version 1.0

简单话 is a highly optimized, radically accessible version of Putonghua designed to function like an elegant "Logic Engine." Its core philosophy can be summarized as: **"Esperanto, but completely valid Mandarin."** It strips away centuries of historical, regional, and socio-cultural bloat, leaving a necessary-and-sufficient linguistic architecture that requires zero guessing from context.

1. Core Structural Guardrails

- Sacred Grammar:** Standard Putonghua grammar is unalterable. 简单话 achieves simplicity exclusively through the AI translation pipeline via strategic editing, hyper-explicit paraphrasing, and vocabulary curation. It never breaks or modifies native syntax.
- Bridge 1 Orthography:** The text layer is entirely Romanized Pinyin with standard dictionary tone marks retained. To bridge the gap between sight and sound without breaking dictionary lookups, **tone sandhi** (acoustic tone morphing like **nǐ hǎo** → **ní hǎo**) is **not** reflected in the written text. The learner reads the pristine lexical identity while the synchronized AI audio engine delivers natural native pronunciation.
- Visual Segmentation:** Text uses German-style hyphenated compound blocks to establish explicit word boundaries, eliminate visual tracking confusion, and reinforce semantic units.

2. The Vocabulary Engine & The Pareto Filter

The lexicon of 简单话 is derived by filtering the standard 5,000-word HSK corpus through a strict mathematical Pareto efficiency threshold to isolate the high-leverage core.

The Core Atom Filter

An HSK word is retained as a **Core Atom** if and only if it satisfies the following algorithmic condition:

Retain if: (Speech Commonality > 70% $\vee$ Writing Commonality > 80%) $\wedge$ Speech Commonality $\geq$ 50%

- Decomposition Rule:** Any word failing this threshold is permanently archived. The AI pipeline must dynamically decompose and rewrite all occurrences of that concept using only the surviving Core Atoms (~1,200 to 1,500 words).
- Hyphenation of Derived Meanings:** Dynamic descriptive replacements are bound into visual blocks using hyphens if it does not violate native grammar (e.g., **nóngjù** [agricultural tools] is unrolled into the core block **nóngmín-gōngjù** [farmer-tools]).

Lexical Monopoly (Synonym Eradication)

To minimize cognitive friction, the vocabulary pool enforces a "one-concept, one-word" rule. Overlapping synonyms are purged, and a single high-frequency designated winner is crowned for every semantic slot:

Concept	Purged Synonyms	Designated Winner
But / However	kěshì, bùguò, rán'ér	dànshì
To think (Opinion)	rènwéi, yǐwéi, xiǎng	juéde

3. Visual & Semantic Partition Laws

To maintain perfect clarity and error-free visual scanning, 简单话 deploys targeted typographical partitions and explicit paraphrases for high-ambiguity structures.

Homophone Collision Mitigation

Single-syllable words with high homophone collision profiles are systematically replaced by unique polysyllabic compound synonyms or structurally anchored via hyphenation (e.g., the isolated syllable **shì** is banned for everyday items in favor of **chéngshì** [city], **shìqíng** [matter], or **fángjiān** [room]).

Non-Semantic Boundaries (The Quote Partition)

Words that do not contribute to the strict logical or grammatical flow of a sentence are wrapped in quotation marks. This alerts the reader's brain to parse the string as a raw acoustic or phonetic unit:

- **Onomatopoeia:** Wǒ-de dùzi "gūlū-gūlū" jiào. (My stomach goes "rumble-rumble".)
- **Foreign Loanwords / Transliterations:** Wǒ qù "Lúndūn" chī "qiǎokèlì". (I go to "London" to eat "chocolate".)

Idiom (Chéngyǔ) Unrolling

Classical four-character idioms are entirely stripped from the language. The AI pipeline translates the underlying meaning directly into descriptive phrases:

- *Standard:* huàshé-tiānzú (Drawing a snake and adding feet)
- *简单话:* zuò-le-duōyú-de-shì (Did redundant things)

4. Grammatical & Cognitive Streamlining

Simplification via Paraphrasing

Where standard Mandarin uses ambiguous structural shortcuts, 简单话 mandates hyper-explicit linear paraphrasing:

- **Question-Words-as-Quantifiers:** Using interrogatives for universal statements (e.g., **shéi dōu** for "everyone") is replaced by verbose, clear paraphrasing: **suǒyǒu-de rén** (all people).
- **Correlative Conjunctions:** Dual logical frameworks (e.g., **yīnwèi... suǒyǐ...** [Because... therefore...]) are **kept completely intact** to safeguard the native echoing rhythm of Mandarin logic and argumentation.
- **Separable Verbs:** Verb-object splits (like **shuì-jiào** breaking apart into **shuì-le liǎng-gè xiǎoshí jiào**) are fully supported to respect standard grammar, but the pipeline actively prioritizes non-separable, linear transitive synonyms where available to keep blocks unified.

Stripping Social Deixis & Cultural Layers

Egalitarian, streamlined alternatives are substituted for vocabulary historically dense with socio-cultural, hierarchical, or generational gatekeeping:

- **Measure Words (Classifiers):** The 150+ arbitrary shape-based classifiers are collapsed down to the universal **gè** everywhere, unless a specialized classifier is explicitly required to resolve a severe semantic ambiguity.
- **The Kinship Tree:** Complex relational terminology is completely flattened into analytical, self-explanatory formulas:
- **bóbo** (Paternal older uncle) → **bāba-de-gēgē**

- jiùjiu (Maternal uncle) → māmā-de-xiōngdì
 - **Pronoun Equalization:** Status-driven distinctions are purged. The honorific nín (您) defaults to nǐ (你), and the listener-inclusive zánmen (咱们) is normalized to wǒmen (我们).
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5. Structural & Aspectual Mechanics

Preservation of Cognitive Spatial Engines

Unlike social constructs, Mandarin's **Directional Complements** (xiàqù [down-go / continuation], qílái [up-come / inception]) represent the core spatial-temporal operating system of the Chinese mind. These are **preserved intact** but anchored cleanly to their verbs via hyphens (e.g., xiào-qílái [start laughing], jìxù-xiàqù [continue onward]).

Modular Affixation

To keep the core dictionary lean while maximizing expressive power, 简单话 embraces Esperanto-style dynamic compounding using native structural affixes (-zhě [agent], -xìng [quality], -huà [process], fǎn- [anti-]). Compounding is highly encouraged as long as it preserves absolute clarity (e.g., optimizing "scientist" directly to kēxué-zhě [science-ist] instead of introducing the unique word kēxuéjiā).

Aspect Anchoring

Standard aspect particles (le, zhe, guò) are highly trusted to execute their native duties. However, the moment a particle introduces timeline ambiguity, the pipeline automatically intervenes to inject explicit, hyper-literal time markers:

- *Ambiguous:* Wǒ chī-le.
- *Failsafe 简单话:* Wǒ yǐjīng chī-wán-le (I already eat-finish-completed) OR Wǒ xiànzài kāishǐ chī (I now start to eat).

Abstract Dimensions

For abstract metrics, both primitive oppositional compounds (e.g., dà-xiǎo [big-small / size]) and formal technical suffixes (e.g., sùdù [speed]) are permitted. The translation pipeline dynamically evaluates and serves whichever variant is structurally more common and less ambiguous within the context of the sentence.